

CAMBODIA ACADEMY OF DIGITAL TECHNOLOGY
INSTITUTE OF DIGITAL TECHNOLOGY

Graduate School of Computer Science

Master Program: Course Syllabus (8 September-13/20 October 2025)

Course Information			
Course Title	Soft Skill: Communication, Critical Thinking & problem solving		
Department	Master Program on Data Science & AI		
Course Code		Hour: 15	Credit: 1
Level	Master	Prerequisite	Communication skill, critical thinking, team work and personal development
Course Type	Major ☐ Core ☒ Elective ☐ Other ☐		
Offer in Academic Year	Term 1		
Revision	Version 2, Sep 2025		
Instructor Information			
Instructor	CHUN Bora	Qualification	Master Degree
Mobile	012 909 968	Email	Bora.chun@cadt.edu.kh
Telegram	012 909 968		
Office Hour	8:30 am – 5:00 pm at Career Center		

Classroom: IDG, D310, 8:30-11:45

Course Description

This course introduces students to effective business communication skills, critical thinking and problem solving and effective team work in a company or institution. The course provides both conceptual, theory and examples about how one can effectively and professionally communicate

with one's supervisors and colleagues in the team and dealing effectively with their daily work and in a business affair in Cambodia and internationally. Students will learn how to use theoretical models to evaluate the way people communicate by using both verbal and non-verbal communication. Ultimately, this course aims at strengthening capacity of learners in effective communication skills for written and oral presentations, and good time management skill, personal development and critical thinking so that one will become a smart and effective communicator and manager/leader.

Course Learning Outcomes

By the end of the course, learners should gain the following *knowledge*:

- CLO1: Define what is communication, effective communication, and its process/model
- CLO2: Describes verbal and non-verbal (gesture/body language) communication and different communications styles
- CLO3: Discuss personal development, time management and effective team work
- CLO4: Explain why communication matter and describe barriers to communication

By the end of the course, learners should be able to use the following *skills*:

- CLO5: Demonstrate ability to communicate effectively using one way or two ways communication
- CLO6: Apply effective goal setting, time management, critical thinking and problem solving
- CLO7: Use effective communication style and strategy in class and reflect to the real world of work and practice interpersonal communication including listening, speaking, writing, presenting, and providing and receiving feedback

By the end of the course, learners should develop the following *attitudes*:

- CLO8: Be able to adopt oneself to a diverse work environment and conduct professionally
- CLO9: Be able to behave and communicate with one's supervisors and colleagues in an effective way and professional manner

Learning Level

Course Learning Outcomes		Bloom Taxonomy					
KSA	CLOs	Remember	Understand	Apply	Analyse	Evaluate	Create
Knowledge	CLO1	✓					
	CLO2		✓				
	CLO3			✓			
	CLO4				✓		
Skill	CLO5			✓			
	CLO6				✓		
	CLO7				✓		
Attitude	CLO8			✓			
	CLO9			✓			

Course Outline/Schedule: Every Monday Morning from 8:30-11:45 AM. D310 at IDG

RL: P: BL: SDL denotes *Recap Lecture hours, Practical hours, Blended Learning hours, Self-directed learning hours* respectively

Session/ Date	Topic	Contact Hours				Required Reading	Homework/ Assignments
		RL	P	BL	SDL		
Session 1 8 Sep 2025	Introduction to Effective Communication Skills	1.5				- Syllabus - Ebook, pp 10-17 - Smith, pp 117-121 - Communication Handbook pp.1-2	Read required reading
Session 2 8 Sep 2025	Perspective in comm. & (Elements of comm.)	1.5				- Ebook, pp 18-24 - Team FME pp. 18-21 -Ebook, pp 31-45 -Team FME pp. 9-13	Read required reading Group arrangement
Session 3 15 Sep 2025	Communication Styles	1.5				-Ebook, pp 31-45 -Team FME pp. 9-13	- Read required reading

							- Instruction of a group reflection paper
Session 4 15 Sep 2025	Listening Skills:	1.5				Ebook, pp 46-51 Moore pp. 19-24	Read required reading
22 Sep 2025	Holiday: Pchum Bean Festival						
Session 5 29 Sep 2025	Convincing Comm: The Three Cs of Effective Communication: and Team Work (TBC)	1.5				Smith pp 122-128	Watch Video and response to questions Read required reading
Session 6 29 Sep 2025	Verbal and written communication	1.5				Watch lesson 06	Read required reading Watch videos: Examples of Business Email Writing in English Mid term
Session 7 06 Oct 2025	Goal setting and time management	1.5				Hoover.J. (2009). Time Management, P.p. 10-60	Read required reading
Session 8 06 Oct 2025	Critical thinking, Decision making Problem solving	1.5				Richards.(2015)Problem Solving. Chap 3, 7 & 8	Read required reading Finalised and submit group assignment videos
Session 9 13 Oct 2025	Improving communications and Handling conflicts	1.5				Brody, R. & Nair, M. (2014). Chapter 10: Improving Comm and Handling Conflicts, P.p. 201-218	Read required reading Group reflection paper due

Session 10 13 Oct 2025	Difficult Conversations: How to Discuss What Matters Most.	1.5				Difficult conversations	Read required reading
	Final Exam					Review all sessions	Exam to be administered in class

Learning Resource:

- **Required reading**

Ebooks at BookBoon.com (2010). Effective Communication Skills, MTD Training & Ventus Publishing ApS. Available from. <http://promeng.eu/downloads/training-materials/ebooks/soft-skills/effective-communication-skills.pdf> (Accessed 28 September 2017)

Smith R.D. (2005). Strategic Planning for Public Relations (Second Edition). Phase Two: **Step 6.**

Using Effective Communication p.p 117-153, Buffalo State Colleague, Lawrence Erlbaum Associate, Publisher, Mahwah, New Jersey, London. 2016]

Team FME (2013) Effective Communications, Communication skills. Available from <http://www.free-management-ebooks.com/dldebk-pdf/fme-effective-communication.pdf> [accessed 28 September 2016].

Moore. L.H. (2013). Business Communication: Achieving Result (1st Edition). Download free eBooks at bookboon.com

Brody, R. & Nair, M. (2014). *Effectively managing and leading human service organizations (4th ed.)* United Kingdom: SAGE publications Ltd. Chapter 10: Improving Communications and Handling Conflicts, P.p. 201-218

Hoover.J. (2009). Time Management. Harper Collins e-books

Richards. Th, (2015) Problem Solving: Best Strategies to Decision Making, Critical Thinking and Poritive Thinking, Createspace Independent Publishing Platform

- **Additional Reading Materials**

Communication Handbook, Available at http://aslect.eu/documents/case1_Doing2learn/Doing2learn_Communication_Handbook.pdf

Bobo A.K., Kendall J. & Max S. (2010). Organizing for Social Change. ***Planning and Facilitating Meetings.*** Midwest Academy Manual for Activist.

Stone,D., Patton,B. and Heen,S. (1999) Difficult Conversations: How to Discuss What Matters Most. A High-Level Summary of the Book by Stone, Patton and Heen. Office of Human Resources. The Ohio State University.

Student's Responsibilities

1. Be on time and come with an understanding of the assigned reading/s. Students are expected to attend class and participate in discussions and group activities. If you are unable to attend a particular class for some reason, please let your instructor know ahead of time and understand that poor attendance will affect your grade.
2. Complete class assignments, a outlined in a timely and high-quality fashion. Ask your instructor or classmates if you do not understand anything related to the class.
3. Demonstrate respectful engagement. In this class, we will discuss issues that are sensitive and sometimes controversial. We all come from different perspectives on these issues and it is likely that a variety of opinions will be expressed in the classroom. Instructors and students will share the responsibility of fostering a learning environment that is a supportive, welcoming, and respectful of individual differences and viewpoints.

Plagiarism and Cheating Policy

Students who are suspected of cheating or plagiarism will be warned, mark deducted, not award credit for work (such as exams, homework, assignments, and tests). Students who are accused of being cheating or plagiarized will be confronted directly by the instructor. The instructor will:

- Warn verbally to students who attempt to cheat.
- Deduct 20% for the first cheating/plagiarizing.
- Deduct 50% for the second cheating/plagiarizing.
- Deduct 100% for the third cheating/plagiarizing (paper invalidated).

Method of assessment:

<i>Assignments/Tasks</i>	<i>Percentage (%)</i>
Attendance	10%
Assignment: Reflection paper	30%
Quiz and Midterm	20
Final exam	40%

- **Attendance**

Students must come to the class every session. If you skip any session, you will lose one mark for that session.

- **Assignments: Reflection paper**

Students must submit assignments by the deadlines. If you don't submit the assignment on time, will lose the mark for that assignment. Detail instruction to be provided

- **Quiz and Midterm**

Quiz may be administered at the beginning of most of the sessions. If you are late to the session, you may not be able to carry it out. Midterm exam will be administered in class.

- **Final exam**

Students must come to class to take the final exam.

Rating Scale

Letter Grade	Grade Point	Score	Explanation
A	4.00	85-100	Excellent
B+	3.50	80-84	Very Good
B	70-79	3.0	Good
C+	65-69	2.5	Fairly Good
C	50-60	2.0	Fair
F	<50	0.0	Fail

Academic Accommodations

Please contact the instructor to request for academic accommodations due to a disability or religion affairs.

Course Evaluation

Students will have the opportunity to evaluate the course and the instructors' effectiveness at the mid and/or end of each term using the standardized teaching evaluation form administered by the program.

Students Learning Experience Action Planning (See below)

Week		Contents/Topics	Intended Learning outcomes	Teaching Approach	Delivery modes	Teaching-Learning Activities	Assessment Strategy and methods	Student Behaviours (Think-feel-do)
			Describe what the student should be able to know (Think), do, behave, demonstrate (do), and feel, reflect (feel) in terms of a particular discipline, knowledge, skill and attitude at the end of the learning experience	Appropriate teaching-learning approach or combination of approaches-used to help students to learn and achieve the intended learning outcomes	Relevant delivery mode or combination of delivery modes that best support the main teaching approach	Describe the specific teaching-learning activities you plan to deploy to better engage students in active learning	- Formative and/or summative assessments - Individual or group - Assessment types and weightage	How do you hope this learning experience will impact your students' feeling, thinking, and doing – individually and as a group?
1		Introduction to Effective Communication Skills	- Teacher and students got to know each other - Ground rules adopted - Syllabus gone through - Defined what is communication, effective communication, and its process/model, - Describe one way and two way communication - Discussed communication strategy, approach and barriers of communication	- Lecturing - Group Discussion - Inquiry-based learning - Provide comments and feedbacks	Go through syllabus In class activities Blended of Lecture Short Lecture Sharing Answers	Small Group discussion and presentation	Individual assignment Read assigned readings: Ebook. pp 10-17 Smith, pp 117-121 Communication Handbook pp.1-2	- Effective - Practice how to use one way and two ways communication - Use effective communication strategy, approach and be able to overcome barriers of communication
2		Perspective in and of comm. Elements of comm.	- Be able to describe communication perspectives - Explained good messages and the characteristic of good communicators - Distinguished between different key elements an effective communication		Blended of Lecture Short Lecture Group Discussion Sharing Answers Feedbacks	Brain storming Group discussion PowerPoint Presentation (PPT)	Individual assignment, Read assigned readings: Ebook, pp 18-24 Team FME pp. 18-21 - Ebook, pp 25-30 - Communication	Effective communication with team members at work

							Handbook pp.1-2	
3		Communication Styles	Distinguished between different key styles of an effective communication		Blended of Lecture Group Reflection Feedbacks	- Group discussion, PPT preparation - Group reflection Q&A	Individual assign, Read assigned readings: -Ebook, pp 31-45 -Team FME pp. 9-13	Adapt own style to fit with team members' comm styles
4		Listening Skills:	- Discussed active listening skill and listen in different situation - Became a good and active listener		Blended of Lecture Group Discussion Feedbacks	Lecture - Watch Video - Practice	Individual assign, Read assigned readings: Ebook, pp 46-51 Moore pp. 19-24	Effectively listen in different situation Effective team work
5		Convincing Comm: The Three Cs of Effective Communication: and Team Work	- Used a convincing communication - Practiced verbal and non-verbal communication appropriately - Discuss elements of team work and its effectiveness		Blended of Lecture Short Lecture Group Discussion Sharing Answers Feedbacks	Watch Video - Group discussion, PPT preparation - Group Reflection Q&A	Individual assign, Read assigned readings: Smith pp 122-128	Be able to convince comm, partners Teamwork and Collaboration: Experience collaboration and effective teamwork Open-minded to diversity
6		Verbal and written communication	Applied how to use effective written communication (Business letter and email)		Short Lecture Group Practice Sharing Answers Feedbacks	- PowerPoint Presentation (PPT) - Go through example - Practice, Q&A	Individual assign, Read assigned readings: Ebook, pp 52-58 Communication Handbook pp. 6-8 Moore pp 54-57	Write effective message

7		Goal Setting and time management,	Practice setting SMART goal, time schedule, problem solving skills		Blended of Lecture Group Discussion Reflection and Feedbacks	Group discussion and Reflection Feedback from instructor, Q&A	Individual assign, Read assigned readings: Hoover.J. (2009). Time Management, P.p. 10-60	Team work SMART goal Critical thinking and problem solving skill
8		Problem solving and decision making	Reflection paper/video		Sharing and feedback	Group work, sharing And Feedback from instructor	Reflection paper or group work video	Teamwork and Collaboration Open-minded
9		Improving communications and Handling conflicts	Be able to improving communications skill and handling possible conflicts Discussed type of conflicts and practice how to handle conflicts		Short Lecture Group Discussion Sharing Answers Feedbacks	- Brainstorming - Group discussion - PPT	Individual assign, Read assigned readings: Brody, R. & Nair, M. (2014). Chapter 10: Improving Communication and Handling Conflicts, P.p. 201-218	Communicate well in the team and handle different kind of conflict
10		Difficult Conversations: How to Discuss What Matters Most.	Demonstrated how to deal with difficult conversation with people		Short Lecture Group Dis. Sharing Answers Feedbacks	Group discussion and sharing Feedback from instructor, Q&A	Individual assign, Read assigned readings: Difficult conversations	Strategy to deal with people who if difficult to work with
		Final Exam			In class exam	Exam administered in class	Multiple choice and open-ended question	